

USAIN BOLT

Usain Bolt first marked himself as a track prodigy at the 2002 world junior championships, where he won the 200m at 15 to become the youngest-ever male champion in any event. The tall and lanky youngster, standing 6 feet and 5 inches tall, defied the conventional wisdom that such sprinters are often disadvantaged at the start. This was proved correct to a certain extent when the young Jamaican had a not-so memorable debut at Athens 2004 and finished last in the 2005 world championships final. It was thereafter that Bolt took to 100m and, as they say, the rest is history. Armed with the perfect concoction of attributes — speed, swagger and a never-say-die spirit — he ruled in Beijing, London and again in Rio in 2016. Bolt struck gold not just in the 100m and 200m, but in the 4x100m relay as well (though the Beijing crown has since been stripped because of a teammate's doping infraction). In Beijing, Bolt came through in the 100m and 200m with world records and that too by the widest margins ever recorded in the Games final of the two events.

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